UNIT 39.2 · LEVEL C1

Inversion – negative adverbials

50 questions · 6 parts

Date: _____ Score: _____ / 50

When you finish, check the Answer Key at the end of this unit.

Part A · Multiple Choice (questions 1–10)

Circle the letter of the correct answer.

1 Hardly _____ the house when it started to rain.

a) I had left **b)** did I leave **c)** had I left **d)** I left

2 No sooner had she sat down _____ the phone rang.

a) than **b)** when **c)** then **d)** as

3 Under no circumstances _____ the emergency door.

a) you should open **b)** you open **c)** do you open **d)** should you open

4 On no account _____ left alone.

a) the children must be **b)** must the children be
c) do the children be **d)** the children be

5 At no time _____ that the machine was dangerous.

a) he said **b)** did he say **c)** said he **d)** he did say

6 Nowhere in the world _____ such hospitality.

a) I found **b)** I have found **c)** did I found **d)** have I found

7 Scarcely _____ the door when the alarm went off.

a) had she closed **b)** she had closed **c)** did she close **d)** she closed

8 In no way _____ responsible for the accident.

a) I am **b)** I be **c)** am I **d)** do I am

9 Not once _____ to apologise.

a) he offered **b)** he did offer **c)** offered he **d)** did he offer

10 By no means _____ the end of the story.

a) is it **b)** does it be **c)** it be **d)** it is

Part B · Fill in the Gaps (questions 11–20)

Write the missing word in each blank.

11 Hardly had we arrived _____ it started to snow.

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

12 No sooner had he left _____ she started crying.

13 Under no circumstances _____ you open this door.

14 On no _____ should you share your password.

15 At no _____ did the manager lose his temper.

16 Never _____ I seen such a mess.

17 Nowhere _____ you find better pizza than here.

18 In no way _____ I responsible for this.

19 Not once _____ she complain about the pay.

20 By no _____ is the project finished.

Part C · Unscramble the Words (questions 21–28)

Put the words in the correct order to make a sentence. Write it on the line. Remember the capital letter and the full stop.

21 **hardly / had / we / sat / down / when / it / rained**

_____

22 **no / sooner / had / he / left / than / she / called**

_____

23 **under / no / circumstances / should / you / open / the / door**

_____

24 **on / no / account / must / you / tell / anyone**

_____

25 **at / no / time / did / she / lie / to / us**

_____

26 **nowhere / have / I / seen / such / kindness**

_____

27 **in / no / way / am / I / responsible**

_____

28 **not / once / did / he / say / sorry**

_____

Part D · Choose and Complete (questions 29–35)

Choose the correct option and write it in the blank.

29 *Choose the inverted verb phrase.*
Hardly _____ the house when it started to rain.
Options: **had I left** / **I had left** / **I left**

30 *Choose the linking word.*
No sooner had we arrived _____ the party ended.
Options: **than** / **when** / **as**

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

31 *Choose the modal.*
Under no circumstances _____ you leave the building.
Options: **should** / **are** / **have**

32 *Choose the modal.*
On no account _____ the children be left alone.
Options: **do** / **must** / **are**

33 *Choose the auxiliary.*
At no time _____ he admit the mistake.
Options: **was** / **did** / **has**

34 *Choose the auxiliary.*
Nowhere _____ I met such friendly people.
Options: **did** / **have** / **am**

35 *Choose the verb.*
By no means _____ this the end of the road.
Options: **does** / **has** / **is**

Part E · Matching (questions 36–40)

Match the items. Write the correct letter next to each number.

36 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. Hardly had I arrived _____
2. No sooner had she left _____
3. Not once did he _____
4. Under no circumstances should _____

A. than he arrived.
B. you tell anyone.
C. when it began to rain.
D. apologise.

37 Match each normal sentence to its inverted version.

1. He did not say a word. _____
2. I am in no way to blame. _____
3. You must not touch it on any account. _____
4. She had hardly sat down when the bell rang. _____

A. Hardly had she sat down when the bell rang.
B. Not a word did he say.
C. In no way am I to blame.
D. On no account must you touch it.

38 Match each expression to its meaning.

1. Not once _____
2. Nowhere _____
3. At no time _____
4. No sooner … than _____

A. Immediately after something else
B. At no moment
C. In no place
D. Not even one time

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

39 Match each trigger to its partner word.

1. Hardly _____ **A.** than
2. No sooner _____ **B.** but also
3. Not only _____ **C.** nor
4. Neither _____ **D.** when

40 Match each beginning to its ending.

1. On no account must _____ **A.** complain.
2. Hardly had he _____ **B.** you tell her.
3. Not once did she _____ **C.** felt so welcome.
4. Nowhere have I _____ **D.** finished when the phone rang.

Part F · Find the Error (questions 41–50)

Each sentence has one mistake. Underline it and write the correct word.

41 Hardly I had sat down when the phone rang.
Correct word: _____

42 No sooner had she arrived when the meeting started.
Correct word: _____

43 Under no circumstances you should leave the building.
Correct word: _____

44 On no account the children must be left alone.
Correct word: _____

45 At no time he mentioned the problem. Correct word: _____

46 Nowhere I have seen such beautiful scenery.
Correct word: _____

47 In no way I am responsible for this. Correct word: _____

48 Not once he said thank you. Correct word: _____

49 Scarcely had she left than the phone rang.
Correct word: _____

50 By no means it is certain that she will win.
Correct word: _____

Your score

Count one point for each correct answer. Below 70%? Review the topic and try the unit again in a few days.

A	B	C	D	E	F	Total
____ / 10	____ / 10	____ / 8	____ / 7	____ / 5	____ / 10	____ **/ 50**

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

UNIT 39.2 · LEVEL C1

Answer Key

Inversion – negative adverbials

Part A · Multiple Choice

1	**c)** had I left	Hardly + had + subject + past participle.
2	**a)** than	No sooner is followed by than.
3	**d)** should you open	Negative adverbial + auxiliary + subject.
4	**b)** must the children be	Put the modal before the subject.
5	**b)** did he say	Add did before the subject.
6	**d)** have I found	Nowhere + auxiliary + subject.
7	**a)** had she closed	Scarcely + had + subject + participle.
8	**c)** am I	With be, put be before the subject.
9	**d)** did he offer	Not once + did + subject + base verb.
10	**a)** is it	By no means + be + subject.

Part B · Fill in the Gaps

11	**when** (or: before)	Hardly goes with when.
12	**than**	No sooner goes with than.
13	**should** (or: must, may, can)	Negative adverbial + modal + subject.
14	**account**	Fixed phrase: on no account.
15	**time**	Fixed phrase: at no time.
16	**have** (or: had)	Never + auxiliary + subject.
17	**will** (or: can, would, could)	Nowhere + modal + subject.
18	**am**	In no way + be + subject.
19	**did**	Not once + did + subject.
20	**means**	Fixed phrase: by no means.

Part C · Unscramble the Words

21	**Hardly had we sat down when it rained.**	Hardly + had + subject.
22	**No sooner had he left than she called.**	No sooner … than.
23	**Under no circumstances should you open the door.**	Modal before the subject.
24	**On no account must you tell anyone.**	Modal before the subject.
25	**At no time did she lie to us.**	Did + subject + base verb.
26	**Nowhere have I seen such kindness.**	Nowhere + have + subject.
27	**In no way am I responsible.**	Be before the subject.

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.

28	**Not once did he say sorry.**	Did + subject + base verb.

Part D · Choose and Complete

29	**had I left**	Hardly + had + subject.
30	**than**	No sooner goes with than.
31	**should**	Modal before the subject.
32	**must**	Modal before the subject.
33	**did**	Did + subject + base verb.
34	**have**	Nowhere + have + subject + participle.
35	**is**	Be before the subject.

Part E · Matching

36	**1-C 2-A 3-D 4-B**	Hardly had I arrived – when it began to rain.; No sooner had she left – than he arrived.; Not once did he – apologise.; Under no circumstances should – you tell anyone. Each adverbial triggers inversion.
37	**1-B 2-C 3-D 4-A**	He did not say a word. – Not a word did he say.; I am in no way to blame. – In no way am I to blame.; You must not touch it on any account. – On no account must you touch it.; She had hardly sat down when the bell rang. – Hardly had she sat down when the bell rang. Put the auxiliary before the subject.
38	**1-D 2-C 3-B 4-A**	Not once – Not even one time; Nowhere – In no place; At no time – At no moment; No sooner … than – Immediately after something else Each adverbial has its own meaning.
39	**1-D 2-A 3-B 4-C**	Hardly – when; No sooner – than; Not only – but also; Neither – nor Some adverbials need a partner word.
40	**1-B 2-D 3-A 4-C**	On no account must – you tell her.; Hardly had he – finished when the phone rang.; Not once did she – complain.; Nowhere have I – felt so welcome. Choose the natural ending.

Part F · Find the Error

41	**had I sat**	Put had before the subject.
42	**than**	Use no sooner … than.
43	**should you** (or: must you)	Put the modal before the subject.
44	**must the children**	Put the modal before the subject.
45	**did he mention**	Add did before the subject.
46	**have I seen**	Put have before the subject.
47	**am I**	Put be before the subject.
48	**did he say**	Add did and use the base verb.
49	**when** (or: before)	Scarcely goes with when.
50	**is it**	Put be before the subject.

© D.C English Classes. For personal use only. Please do not copy or share.